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Sunny, windy 59/42 • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 58/41 **B18**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 12, 2025 • \$4

Wall Street ebullience spurs fears of a bubble

As Washington relaxes bank rules, industry gets more room to take risks

BY ANDREW ACKERMAN

Wall Street is getting a lot of what it has long wanted out of Washington, even as some bank executives and market watchers warn that financial markets are overexuberant and potentially combustible.

Regulators installed by President Donald Trump are laying the groundwork to deliver on the banking industry's wish list, from faster merger approvals to less-onerous rules for financial buffers that protect against losses. While officials dial back the intensity of regulation and the way they apply rules on thousands of banks, some of the biggest names in finance, including the CEOs of Morgan Stanley and Goldman Sachs, are saying that financial markets could be due for a significant correction, as stocks hover near record highs on enthusiasm over artificial intelligence.

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent has spearheaded the push to relax bank rules, casting deregulation as a cornerstone of Trump's economic strategy, although Wall Street has long argued for looser rules, saying that regulators clamped down too much after the financial crisis that triggered the Great Recession.

Coming off one of their strongest quarters ever, big banks are poised to benefit from more room to take risks, with less-

SEE WALL STREET ON A13

Israel hotly debates prosecution of soldiers

Alleged sexual abuse of a Hamas detainee sparks questions on rule of law

BY SHIRA RUBIN
AND LIOR SOROKA

TEL AVIV — The resignation and subsequent detention of Israel's chief military lawyer, after she leaked a video showing part of an incident in which soldiers allegedly sexually abused a detained Palestinian, are kindling fierce debate in Israel over the bounds of what is legal and socially acceptable in times of war.

In what has become one of the most contentious cases in Israeli military history, Maj. Gen. Yifat Tomer-Yerushalmi stepped down late last month after admitting she had authorized the leak of surveillance footage showing part of the assault on an alleged Hamas member held in Sde Teiman, a notorious desert detention center. She said in her resignation letter that she had concerns that a once "basic understanding — that these are acts that must not be committed, even against the most despicable of detainees — no longer convinces everyone."

In a tweetstorm, Israeli De-

SEE ISRAEL ON A12

America marks Veterans Day



TOM BRENNER/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

U.S. Army veteran Charles Elder touches the name of a fallen friend Tuesday at the Vietnam Veterans Memorial in Washington. Across the Potomac River, President Donald Trump laid a wreath at Arlington National Cemetery.

Aircraft carrier nears Latin America amid buildup

BY TARA COPP

The USS Gerald R. Ford aircraft carrier has entered waters near Latin America, joining a massive naval buildup that has fueled speculation the Trump administration intends to dramatically escalate its deadly counternarcotics campaign there, possibly through direct attacks on Venezuela.

The Ford and its three accompanying warships arrived in the region Tuesday, the Navy said in a news release. The ships were not yet in the Caribbean Sea but had crossed into the U.S. Southern Command's jurisdiction, a vast

Arrival in region adds to speculation that U.S. will attack Venezuela

area that also includes part of the Atlantic Ocean and drug smuggling routes in the Pacific used by cartels based in Colombia and neighboring Ecuador.

"These forces will enhance and augment existing capabilities to disrupt narcotics trafficking and degrade and dismantle transnational criminal organizations,"

Pentagon spokesman Sean Parnell said in a statement.

The development, though forecast weeks ago, appeared certain to deepen the sense of unease felt in some corners of Congress since President Donald Trump began to ruminate about a potential regime change in Venezuela. Last week, administration officials hoping to quash bipartisan legislation aimed at restraining the president's ability to unleash military force there told lawmakers no active preparations were underway for such an attack — a declaration that persuaded enough Republicans to vote down the measure.

The breadth of firepower inherent to an aircraft carrier strike group — the Ford typically travels with dozens of fighter jets and an assortment of other lethal capabilities — would seem excessive for the type of strikes that U.S. forces have carried out on alleged drug boats since early September, experts said.

Carriers are strategic assets, and the United States uses its fleet of 11 — many of which are in scheduled maintenance and not available to sail at any given time — for power projection and deterrence in its top-tier security

SEE VENEZUELA ON A2

An old manufacturing city sputters back to life

Once-thriving industrial hub had bottomed out. Today, employers can't fill the jobs fast enough.

BY IRINA IVANOVA

Daniel Velazquez wasn't sure what to do with himself after high school. The Bridgeport, Connecticut, native loved football and basketball, but a sports career wasn't in the cards. He had heard about welding programs nearby and he liked to work with his hands, so he signed up for a nine-month certificate at the University of Bridgeport. Two weeks after graduation, the 19-year-old was hired full-time to build boating equipment at RowAmerica, an elite rowing accessory manufacturer.

"If you had told me a few months ago that I would be getting hired two weeks after finishing the program, I would never have believed you," Velazquez says. He is the first of his peer group to complete his education and enter the workforce, and, at \$25 an hour, the job is a welcome boost from his previous role making just above Connecticut's \$16.35 minimum wage at a local recycling plant.

And he loves the work because it requires focus: "Aluminum can be brittle. It's easy to screw up what you're doing and make it unusable, so you really have to be paying attention."

Velazquez is one of 50 graduates in 2025 of Goodwin University's welding program, which started in 2018 with just four students in East Hartford and expanded its program to the University of Bridgeport campus in 2023. The program helps businesses find welders, machinists, mechatronics technicians, engineering technicians and robotics technicians, among other workers. Even with the program's rapid growth, it's still not enough to meet the need for skilled-trades workers, says Clifford Thermer, dean of the School of Business, Management and Advanced Manufacturing at Goodwin.

"The jobs are there but the people are not," Thermer says.

In fact, Connecticut has 5,000 manufacturing jobs to fill, according to the state Department of Labor. Eighty per-

SEE BRIDGEPORT ON A8

No clear victor in subsidy standoff

DEMOCRATS FACE IMMEDIATE FURY

But Republicans could feel fallout in midterms

BY HANNAH KNOWLES,
NATALIE ALLISON,
EMILY DAVIES
AND THEODORIC MEYER

The votes by a handful of Democratic senators this week to end a government shutdown without key concessions from Republicans have left the party bruised and divided, struggling to explain to a furious base why they folded without securing the health care subsidies they called essential. For many this was a head-scratching defeat, just days after election triumphs showed voters were on their side.

But the closing chapter to the more than 40-day standoff, and the underlying fight over extending tax credits under the Affordable Care Act, could prove perilous for Republicans in the long term. President Donald Trump's own pollsters and allies have warned that not extending the health care subsidies would amount to a major political risk in the midterms, and the public has shown it will blame a shutdown on the party in power —

SEE SHUTDOWN ON A6

Tougher tactics: Democrats toss old rules in fight against Trump. **A5**

Flight cuts: Air travel timeline hazy amid possible shutdown end. **A7**

Justices again side with Trump on SNAP

Pause on lower-court order remains, but it could soon be irrelevant

BY MARK BERMAN

The U.S. Supreme Court on Tuesday kept in place a pause on a lower-court order that had directed the Trump administration to pay full food assistance benefits to millions of Americans, preventing federal officials, for now, from having to provide the aid.

The high court's order said it was keeping the lower court's ruling paused through 11:59 p.m. Thursday. The Supreme Court's order Tuesday evening provided no explanation, as is typical in the court's responses to emergency requests, but came amid signs that the funding issue could soon be resolved by other government officials.

A high-stakes court battle has been waged recently over Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) benefits, vital funding that helps 42 million people nationwide — or about 1 in 8 Americans — afford groceries. With the federal government shut down, the SNAP program ran out of funding Nov. 1.

SEE SNAP ON A7

IN THE NEWS

Arrest in cold case A man who spent 10 years in prison for stabbing a D.C. woman in 2004 has been charged in a 1999 killing after DNA tests allegedly linked him to the crime. **B13**

A bet on Black history Tourism-minded GOP-led states pour millions into museums, even as the president decries such efforts. **A15**

THE NATION

Families of Texas flood victims sued Camp Mystic and its managers, alleging negligence. **A4**
A judge's redistricting ruling in Utah is likely to give Democrats a U.S. House seat. **A4**

THE WORLD

Syria's president spoke with The Washington Post after his White House visit. **A10**
At least 12 people were killed in a suicide bombing in Pakistan's capital. **A11**

THE ECONOMY

A 50-year mortgage, floated by the president, could mean monthly savings for buyers but would be costlier in other ways, according to housing economists. **A14**

STYLE

For a peek into strangers' minds, we looked at their Notes app. **B1**

SPORTS

The top five remained unchanged in the College Football Playoff rankings, but movement hit the lower echelons. **B7**
The Nats are open for business as MLB's general manager meetings open in Las Vegas with new chief Paul Toboni running the show. **B7**

THE REGION

The former landlord of the Marbury Plaza apartments in Southeast Washington was ordered to pay \$41 million over squalid conditions. **B13**

FOOD

Raid the pantry and fridge for a quick, off-the-cuff soup that bursts with flavor. **E1**

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